

Be Still and Become Present

Allow approximately an hour to an hour and a half, including the walk. This is not a timed exercise. Take breaks and move at your own pace. Nothing here is graded. A blank line is an honest answer.

1 • Check-in

Briefly. This is a check-in, not a test.

1. Right now, where is your attention? In this room, or somewhere else? If somewhere else, where: the past, the future, another place, another person?

2. When you try to bring your attention back to now, what pulls it away again? Name the strongest pull.

3. On a scale from “mostly attentive to this room” to “strongly pulled elsewhere,” where would you place yourself? No right answer.

4. What situation currently feels unstable, loud, or beyond your control? Name it in one line without analysing or solving it.

If you feel unreal, disconnected from your body, unable to recognise where you are, or as though you are reliving another time, pause the session and ground yourself (Lesson 5).

3 • Silence

Fifteen minutes, or the length you managed this morning. Anchor phrase: “Be still, and know that I am God.” Or: “God is here.” The coming back is the practice.

4 • Journal

1. Where did your attention go during the silence? List the places. Which one did it return to most often?

2. When have you recognised, or felt, God's help in your life? If you cannot identify such a time, say so honestly. Your inability to recall an experience does not make the psalm's declaration untrue, and Session 7 will return to this.

3. The disciples were afraid because the boat was filling. What reasonable fear makes it difficult for you to remember or trust that Christ remains with you?

4. Finish this sentence: "If I gave this present moment my attention without trying to solve the past or anticipate the future, I would notice..."

5 · A walk of noticing (20 to 30 minutes, or seated somewhere new)

- ☐ **See.** For the first few minutes, notice only what you can see.
- ☐ **Hear.** Then, for a few minutes, notice only what you can hear.
- ☐ **Feel.** Then what you can feel: the ground under your feet, the air on your skin, the temperature, your own breathing if that is comfortable for you.
- ☐ **Smell.** Then, if you are outdoors, what you can smell.
- ☐ **All at once.** Finally, walk the last few minutes with all of it at once, simply present in the place where you are, repeating your anchor phrase if it helps.

What did I notice?

If you feel unsafe, faint, confused, severely distressed, or disoriented, stop moving and go to the nearest safe, familiar place. Contact your designated person or appropriate help. Do not continue walking, and do not drive, while disoriented. Immediate danger, chest pain, fainting or severe breathlessness: call your local emergency number. Thoughts of harming yourself, or not being able to stay safe: call your local emergency number or a crisis line now.

6 · Closing declaration

Read only what you can say honestly. Adjust the words if you need to.

God is a very present help.

The storm is real, and Christ is with me in it.

I am learning to be here, in this hour, in this place.

Every time I wander, I will come back.